



2014

Space skydive

US engineer Alan Eustace travelled into space in a gas-powered balloon, before skydiving 40 km (25 miles) back down to Earth, parachuting to the ground moments before landing. The journey lasted 15 minutes and set a new world record for the highest and longest freefall.

Also on this day

1945 The United Nations (UN) was officially established, with 50 countries agreeing to maintain international peace, prioritize human rights, and promote progress and prosperity.

1975 Most women in Iceland went on strike for the day to protest against inequality in the workplace. It led to a new law that ensured equal pay for women and men.

October

24



1929

Black Thursday

The New York stock market crashed, triggering the collapse of the US economy. This led to the Great Depression, a period of worldwide economic hardship that lasted through the 1930s.

Born this day

1632 Antonie van Leeuwenhoek, Dutch scientist. Known as the Father of Microbiology, he built hundreds of microscopes to study tiny bacteria in great detail.

1986 Drake, Canadian actor, rapper, and singer. He began his career on a teen television programme before moving into music. One of the biggest names in hip-hop today, he has sold more than 170 million records worldwide.

1901

Daring drop

On her 63rd birthday, US teacher Annie Edson Taylor climbed into a barrel and plunged 51 m (167 ft) down Niagara Falls in Canada. She was the first person to survive the drop, escaping with only minor cuts and bruises.

